

**** Report on the Laws of Citizens in India ****

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REPORT ON THE LAWS OF CITIZENS IN INDIA

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The Citizenship Act of 1955 is the primary law in India that regulates citizenship. It has been amended several times, most recently in 2019. The Act provides for the following ways to acquire Indian citizenship:

* ****By birth:**** A person born in India on or after January 26, 1950, but before July 1, 1987, is a citizen of India by birth, irrespective of the nationality of their parents. A person born in India on or after July 1, 1987, is a citizen of India if either of their parents was a citizen of India at the time of their birth. * ****By descent:**** A person born outside India on or after January 26, 1950, but before December 10, 1992, is a citizen of India by descent if their father was a citizen of India at the time of their birth. A person born outside India on or after December 10, 1992, is a citizen of India if either of their parents was a citizen of India at the time of their birth. * ****By registration:**** A person of Indian origin who has been a resident of India for seven years before making an application for registration can acquire Indian citizenship by registration. * ****By naturalization:**** A person who has been a resident of India for twelve years (with some exceptions) and who meets certain other qualifications can acquire Indian citizenship by naturalization.

The Citizenship Act also provides for the termination of Indian citizenship in the following ways:

* ****By renunciation:**** A citizen of India can renounce their citizenship by making a declaration to that effect. * ****By termination:**** A citizen of India who voluntarily acquires the citizenship of another country automatically ceases to be a citizen of India. * ****By deprivation:**** The Central Government can deprive a citizen of India of their citizenship if they have acquired it by fraud, false representation, or concealment of any material fact.

The Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019 (CAA) has been a subject of controversy. The CAA amends the Citizenship Act, 1955 to make it easier for non-Muslim migrants from Afghanistan, Bangladesh, and Pakistan who entered India on or before December 31, 2014, to acquire Indian citizenship. The CAA has been criticized for being discriminatory against Muslims and for violating the secular principles of the Indian Constitution.

In addition to the Citizenship Act, there are a number of other laws that affect the rights of citizens in India. These include the Constitution of India, which guarantees certain fundamental rights to all citizens, and the Indian Penal Code, which defines and punishes crimes.

The laws of citizenship in India are complex and have been the subject of much debate. It is important to understand these laws in order to protect your rights as a citizen of India.

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